Neuroscience and Behaviour Management.

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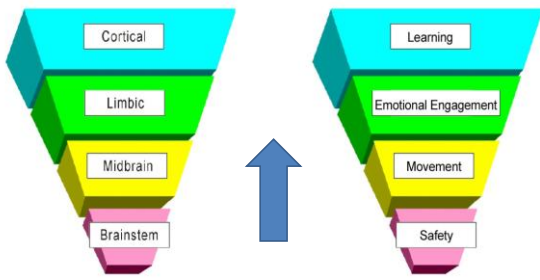
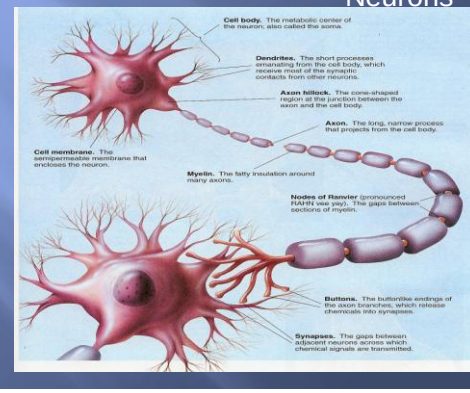
Ahakoa he iti, he pounamu.



Adapted from: McCaleb, M. & Mikaere-Wallis, N. Relationship-shaping: Teacher consistency and implications for brain development. *The First Years/Ngā Tau Tuatahi: New Zealand Infant and Toddler Education*, *7*(2), 21-25

Neurons

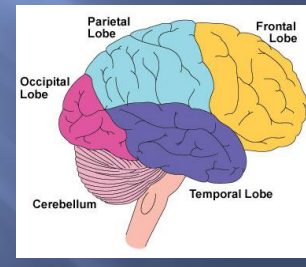


If we imagine the brain as a garden....

Endorphins = Fertilizer

Cortisol = weed killer

- Work *with* the parietal lobe



Wheelbarrow Language

Words like 'nice' 'good' and 'careful' are difficult to picture.
Use concrete/wheelbarrow terms.

Rephrase the following...

stop hitting your sister

don't touch the vase

be a good boy

First Deal with YOUR behaviour

Are your expectations developmentally appropriate?

*Consider how much cortex they have

*Do the adults you know achieve this all the time? Do YOU??

You encourage the growth of empathy by modelling it. Are you really empathetic of what it's like to be a child?

This might help...Lol!

Where does aggression come from?

Evolution
selective breeding for aggression

Socialisation
harsher on boys

What makes it worse according to research?

Love withdrawl
Undermines sense of worth

inconsistency

punishment

What makes it better according to research?

Cognitive training
explaining with respect exactly what behaviour you DO want to see. TEACH them!

Induction
"Big boys can put there shoes on"

Reward desirable behaviour

Relationship Frameworks

Brick Wall
don't answer back - just do it or else!

Jelly Fish
No. No. Oh alright then...

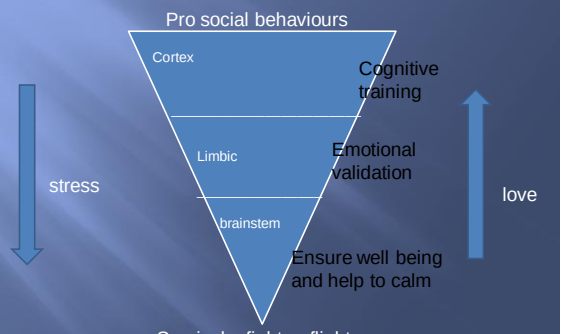
Backbone
I listen to you, you listen to me, we compromise within set boundaries

Remember.....

Language literally programmes the brain,
so program the brain with the language of love, of hope, of pride, support and joy.
What language fills our home?
Are we *reactive* or proactive?
And.....

The Vagus Nerve

Responding to Challenging Behaviour



Child A walks up to child B and pushes him away to take the toy. How do you respond if the child is.....

- 2 years
- 4 years

For the child already in the Brainstem....

same principles apply

more attachment = more compliance

immerse in prosocial environment

only use inclusive time out as a last resort and move quickly back to positive reinforcement.